Table 8-32. *PCRE character classes*

`[^dgAF]`	Any character except d, g, A, F
`[0-9]`	The full range of decimal digits, equivalent to `\d`
`[a-zA-Z]`	All upper and lowercase Latin alphabet characters.

`[\dABCDEF]`
`[\dA-F]`
`[0-9A-F]`
	Will match a hexadecimal digit

`[\.\-,!]`	Match any of `.-,!` punctuation chars

The caret character also takes a new role in character classes by negating them. Thus, `[^0-9]` means "any character that is not a decimal digit," `[^a-f]` is "any character that is not lowercase abcdef," and so on. Here's a demonstration:

```
$text = 'Highly Irregular Was The Time';
preg_match_all('/[^A-Z]+/', $text, $matches);
print_r($matches[0]);
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => ighly
    [1] => rregular
    [2] => as
    [3] => he
    [4] => ime
)
```

The pattern `/[^A-Z]+/` defines a character class of "anything that isn't an ASCII uppercase letter," greedily matched one or more times; the resulting matches should be self-explanatory.

Alternates

In a similar way to character classes, the pipe character | can be used with grouping to define alternative byte sequences for matching.